

"YOUR PERFORMANCE IS AN IMAGE OF YOURSELF."

Rajyavardhan Singh Rathore

Bull's eye. Rajyavardhan Singh Rathore redefined the meaning of the term for Indians when he won the silver at the Athens Olympics, India's best individual performance at the games. But for the Army officer, the medal was just another victory, and the silver only weighed with the missed opportunities that separated him from gold-medallist Sheikh Ahmed Al-Maktoum of the UAE.



AP PHOTO/DOUGLAS C. PIZAC

● *The Return of the King* proved to be a fitting end to the *Lord of the Rings* fantasy trilogy as it bagged an Oscar in every category in which it was nominated with 11 wins in total.

REUTERS



- Four blasts (above) in rush-hour local trains killed 190 persons and injured over 2,000 in Madrid on March 11.
- In its largest expansion ever, European Union extended its sphere of influence over 10 states on May 1.
- Russian forces put an end to a siege at a school in Beslan on September 3. At least 335 people were killed.



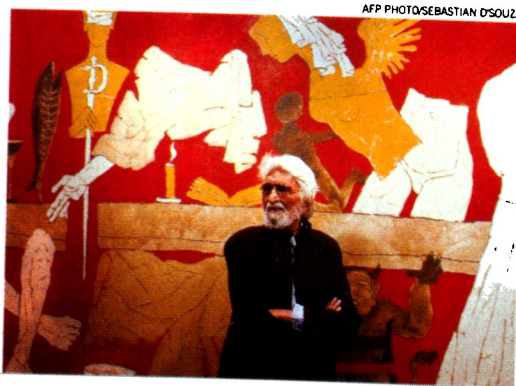
BHASKAR PAUL

Ode to Life

After having sung 50,000 songs in over 20 languages, the nightingale of India, Lata Mangeshkar, turned 75 on September 28. And as if to prove her eternal youth, she belted out another superhit soundtrack for Yash Chopra's *Veer Zaara* that year.

100 CRORE, 125 PAINTINGS

It was raining moolah for painter M.F. Husain. Known for inciting controversy, this time he made news when he signed a deal with industrialist Guru Swarup Srivastava for 125 oil paintings from his "Our Planet Called Earth" series for Rs 100 crore—the questions would come later. Days before the sale of Tyeb Mehta's *Mahishasura*, Husain could grab headlines without having to run for cover.



AFP PHOTO/SEBASTIAN D'SOUZA

309

was the number of runs that Virender Sehwag scored in the first match against Pakistan at Multan during the Friendship Series. Anil Kumble too shone bright in the series as he broke Kapil Dev's record of 434 test wickets.